

documenting valuable public information online, and improving public access and awareness to a government of information, making for an informed citizenship. Government portals help to provide a faster, more detailed and efficient service to the general public, and provide a government gateway for citizens seeking information regarding government services.

Community Portals

Community portals provide improved communication and contact with a community online providing local or community based information. They are the most widespread platform used by communities to inform electronically. Members can find information and contribute relevant shared information to others within the portal. Community portals provide an awareness and interaction amongst a community whether for profit or non-profit. They provide an online collaboration space for a community of certain interest. Community portals replace the traditional means of keeping a community informed via libraries and publishing. They help to provide an online global community and communication agora and to strengthen the communities by informing them and providing an open place for communication, interaction, and the exchange of information and ideas.

Semantic Community Portals

Semantic web technologies are used to enrich community portals. Most modern web portals process and share information amongst their members through a personalized central point. Most queries in searching for information are keyword based. The current web technologies are a serious limitation in making information accessible for users in an efficient manner [1]. The use of ontologies and semantic web technologies will enable web portals to become more efficient at the task of sharing information. A semantic web portal makes information accessible to both humans and software agents from a semantic viewpoint. Most web portals today do not provide machine processable information. Semantic community portals can provide high quality searching features by providing semantic based browsing, querying and searching by making